

Singapore's specialty coffee scene (filter/single-origin focused) remains vibrant and technically oriented as of 2025–2026, with strong emphasis on light/Nordic-style roasts, seasonal single origins, and enthusiast-driven spots. Apartment Coffee's consistent global recognition (No. 6 worldwide and top in Asia in both 2025 and 2026 World's 100 Best Coffee Shops) underscores the scene's maturity.²⁹¹

Your preference for **filter > espresso**, washed-process clarity, high-altitude Ethiopians/Colombians, technical execution, and transparency aligns exceptionally well with several top venues. I've prioritized filter-first spots and flagged alignments. All info cross-verified via recent Reddit (r/pourover, etc.), cafe sites, and 2025–2026 sources; unverifiable claims are flagged.

SECTION 1: VERIFIED ESTABLISHED SPECIALTY CAFES (Filter/Single-Origin Focused)

Ranked roughly by community consensus for serious filter work (Reddit r/pourover 2025 threads and recent reviews).

- **Apartment Coffee** (Selegie Road; also roastery expansion in Serangoon ~2025)
Filter Commitment: 5/5 | Single-Origin Depth: 5/5 | Equipment: 5/5 | Roastery: 5/5 | Origin Diversity: 5/5 | Reputation: 5/5 | Barista Knowledge: 5/5 | Transparency: 5/5 (avg. ~4.9)
World-class filter temple with monthly-changing single-origin menus. Focus on clarity and technical precision. Strong washed Ethiopian/Colombian rotations. **Excellent match for your profile**—baristas explain flavors, varietals, and processes in detail. Still operating strongly; top "holy grail" pick.³²
- **Nylon Coffee Roasters** (4 Everton Park #01-40)
Filter Commitment: 5/5 | Single-Origin Depth: 5/5 | Equipment: 5/5 (in-house Probat) | **Roastery: 5/5 | Origin Diversity: 5/5 | Reputation: 5/5 | Barista Knowledge: 4.5/5 | Transparency: 4.5/5** (avg. ~4.8)
Long-standing roaster-cafe with relationship buying and farm visits. Excellent light roasts and filter focus. You've visited—check for new seasonal lots (they rotate actively). Strong community staple.⁴⁴
- **20grams Coffee Roastery** (14 Arumugam Rd #01-05, MacPherson)
Filter Commitment: 5/5 | Single-Origin Depth: 5/5 | Equipment: High | Roastery: 5/5 (Nordic style) | **Origin Diversity: 5/5 | Reputation: 4.5/5 | Barista Knowledge: 4.5/5 | Transparency: 4.5/5** (avg. ~4.7)
Dedicated Nordic/light roasts emphasizing terroir. Serious filter destination with in-house roasting. Highly praised for clarity.⁶⁵
- **Zerah Coffee Roasters** (465 North Bridge Rd #02-5063)
Filter Commitment: 5/5 | Single-Origin Depth: 4.5/5 | Equipment: High | Roastery: 5/5 | Origin Diversity: 4.5/5 | Reputation: 4.5/5 | Barista Knowledge: 4.5/5 | Transparency: 4/5 (avg. ~4.6)
Micro-roastery/cafe focused on vibrant, balanced single origins. Frequently recommended in enthusiast threads.⁷⁵
- **Fluid Collective** (24 Opal Crescent, Potong Pasir)
Filter Commitment: 5/5 | Single-Origin Depth: High | Equipment: High | Roastery: 5/5 (co-roasting) | **Origin Diversity: 5/5 | Reputation: 4.5/5 | Barista Knowledge: 4.5/5 | Transparency: 4/5** (avg. ~4.6)

Light roasts, community/co-roasting hub. Passionate owners; rotates excellent beans. Strong filter focus.⁸⁵

- **Tiong Hoe Specialty Coffee** (170 Stirling Rd #01-1133; VivoCity outlet)
Filter Commitment: 4/5 | Single-Origin Depth: 4/5 | Equipment: Solid | Roastery: 5/5
(heritage + specialty) | **Origin Diversity: 4.5/5 | Reputation: 4/5 | Barista Knowledge: 4/5**
| Transparency: 4/5 (avg. ~4.3)
You've visited. Bridges heritage and modern specialty; good rotations (e.g., Alo mentions). Still active with strong retail/wholesale.¹⁰

Others with strong filter cred: Homeground Coffee Roasters (roastery + community focus), Pinhole (guest roasters like Slurp/Sey), Maxi Coffee Bar (in-house + international), Asylum (funky/experimental, pricier).⁵⁴

SECTION 2: EMERGING & NEW SPECIALTY CAFES (Post-2023 Openings)

Data is sparser; many build on established roasters.

- **Pocket by Flip** (various; roaster-linked) — Emerging favorite for harder-to-find lots (e.g., Alo). Filter-serious.⁵⁴
- **Rookies / Round Boy Roasters** — Light roasts, in-house, enthusiast-mentioned for pourovers.⁵⁴
- **Pull.in** (near Humble Origins) — Newish; own roast + guest. Promising.
- **Compound Coffee-linked spots** or co-roasts — More roastery-focused but support cafe ecosystem.¹⁰⁵

Flag new openings via Instagram #sgspecialtycoffee or r/pourover for 2026 updates.

SECTION 3: SINGAPORE SPECIALTY ROASTERIES DIRECTORY

Active players emphasize direct/relationship sourcing and light roasts.

- **Nylon Coffee Roasters** (est. ~2012): Relationship buying, farm visits. Light-to-medium, diverse origins. Supplies self + community. Respected veteran.⁴⁴
- **20grams:** Nordic/Scandinavian focus since ~2012. Terroir-driven, sustainable. Light roasts. Cafe + retail.⁶⁵
- **Apartment Coffee** (est. 2018): Technical, competition pedigree. High clarity singles. Top-tier.³
- **Fluid Collective:** Co-roasting hub; seasonal, innovative. Supplies others (e.g., Rookies). Community powerhouse.⁸⁵
- **Alchemist:** Consistent, approachable quality. In-house roasting. Multiple outlets.⁵⁵
- **Tiong Hoe:** Heritage (1960s roots) + modern specialty. Broad sourcing.¹⁰
- **Zerah, Homeground, Compound Coffee Co.** (co-roasting/academy), Cata, Maxi, etc.: Active; many supply cafes.¹¹⁵

Most respected: Apartment, Nylon, 20grams, Fluid. Several supply top cafes. Competition participation (Brewers Cup, etc.) noted for Apartment and others.

SECTION 4: MOST DISCUSSED ORIGINS & BEANS IN SINGAPORE (2024–2026)

- **Top Origins:** Ethiopia (Yirgacheffe/Guji, washed for clarity), Colombia (high-altitude, anaerobic experiments), Kenya (SL28 vibrancy), Panama Gesha, occasional Yemen/Taiwan.²⁸
- **Trending Processes:** Washed (your preference), Anaerobic (natural/washed), Honey, co-ferments. Funkier naturals at Asylum.
- **Varietals:** Gesha, SL28, heirlooms, improved Typica/Parainema. Experimental lots popular.

- **Singapore Angle:** No major local micro-lots, but strong importer/relationship model. Guest roasters (Glitch, Sey, international) via Pinhole/Percolate/Dawn.
- **Pricing:** Premium filter ~SGD 8–15+ per cup at top spots (higher for rares). Beans reflect enthusiast willingness for quality; less price-sensitive than mass market.⁵⁴

Holy Grail vibes: Washed Ethiopian at Apartment or Nylon; Nordic lights at 20grams.

SECTION 5: FILTER BREW EQUIPMENT TRENDS IN SINGAPORE

- **Brewers:** V60, Kalita, Aeropress, batch brew; some Nucleus or high-end pour-over systems. Precision (temp, ratios) emphasized.
- **Grinders:** EK43, Lagom P64, Comandante (home), SSP burrs common for consistency.
- **Water:** Treated/filtered for optimal extraction (common in serious spots).
- **Community:** Reddit praises technical execution; baristas often share ratios/altitudes. Transparency high at top cafes.⁵⁴

SECTION 6: COMMUNITY INTELLIGENCE SUMMARY

Praised by enthusiasts (r/pourover etc.): Apartment (technical king), Nylon, 20grams, Fluid, Zerah, Pinhole (guest beans), Homeground. Focus on roaster-owned or serious filter spots over lifestyle cafes.⁵⁴

Criticisms: Inconsistency at some (e.g., older Kurasu/PPP mentions for temp/ roast), overpriced experimental (Asylum). PPP/CSHH mixed for darker roasts.

Consensus "Best": Apartment for world-class experience; Nylon/20grams for reliable filter depth. Your visited spots (Tiong Hoe, Asylum, etc.) hold up; seek seasonal updates at Nylon/ Apartment.

Key Themes: Light roasts, seasonality, community (co-roasting), rising international guest beans. Instagram (#sgspecialtycoffee, #filtercoffeesg) and Reddit active for real-time.

SECTION 7: VERIFICATION LOG (from seed Reddit threads)

Most mentioned are **operating** (2025–2026 confirmations):

- Apartment: Thriving, globally ranked.²⁹
- Nylon: Active roastery/cafe.⁴⁴
- Tiong Hoe: Multiple outlets, active.¹⁰
- Zerah, 20grams, Fluid, Alchemist, Pinhole, Maxi, Asylum, etc.: Verified via sites/IG/Reddit.
- Others (e.g., Dawn, Pocket by Flip, Round Boy, Homeground): Active per recent mentions.
- No major closures flagged in top filter spots; scene stable/expanding.

Recommendations aligned with your profile: Prioritize **Apartment** (new offerings likely) and **20grams/Nylon** for washed clarity and technical depth. Use apps like coffee finder or IG for current menus. Enjoy the audit—Singapore punches above its weight in filter culture. For deeper dives (specific lots), provide more details!